

Weekly 10

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Weekly Progress (5 points)

1. Started working on setting up the poster on Canva and library resources – haven’t done much of the hard writing and making pretty graphics, but the early setup and familiarizing myself with the format.
2. Started writing up the methodology for the final report and for the poster (and also to email to Prof. Majhi). This involved collecting a bunch of info from various sources on QCA that I’ve been using, predominantly one textbook, to explain the math behind it and the statistics and (potentially later) the actual functions used in R for it.
3. Wrote an early version of an abstract for the poster and final report – the final results may vary a little following this week’s last steps for the analysis, but it should be good for the time being. Next up is the introduction!
4. Read some literature on peacekeeping operations post-war to have a better background on it – mostly Foreign Affairs articles (no notable standouts, just a decent bit of background and examples), and a couple articles I had already downloaded.
5. Started manually adding a column to both data frames for whether or not a UN peacekeeping mission was present after the EndYear but before the following StartYear (if one existed). This is crisp-set, so it shouldn’t add too much complexity once it’s done.

Challenges (3 points)

1. One thing that is unfortunate is that though crisp-set QCA is relatively easy to understand from a statistical perspective – all of the statistics are pretty clearly derived when you see the formulas and make sense with set theory – when you extend this to fuzzy-set QCA it becomes both less frequently discussed and substantially more complicated (the 2^k rows in a crisp-set truth table become just, much larger for fuzzy-set QCA). Though the ideas can be easily communicated through crisp-set language, my understanding of these processes in fsQCA are just unsatisfyingly subpar. I’ll have to do more research on this in particular (which is hard when there’s not enough resources on it), for myself and for the poster presentation.
2. As far as I’m aware, for the peacekeeping mission variable I’m adding, it really can only be done manually. It’s not so many cases that there’s no way I could do it manually, but just enough that it’s a little bit of a pain. There are datasets of peacekeeping missions, but getting actual dates/process is a bit harder. Oh well. It’s good for learning I suppose.
3. My current main challenge for next week is determining whether or not the difference in the combinations of factors leading to the outcome in question are actually significantly different – maybe some analysis of the full dataset including all the combinations of factors will be useful, but I’m still foggy on what statistical processes can evaluate this.

Code Commits (2 points)

1. Writeup of methodology complete and refined question for Prof. Majhi:
<https://github.com/GW-datasci/26-spring-LUTZ-H/commit/bae4b223c064ae1ee6c4209055b55b17811724d5>
2. Wrote abstract, began manually adding peacekeeping operation variable:
<https://github.com/GW-datasci/26-spring-LUTZ-H/commit/89fdc18c0b755640c8567de6043884c3ac7c1d5a>